



FREE GUIDE · FOR PODIATRY

The Podiatry Practice's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Surgical and injection sharps, wound-care
biohazard, and meds — every stream.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

More than nail clippings.

Podiatry practices generate surgical and injection sharps, wound-care and nail-procedure biohazard, and expired medications. In-office procedures mean regulated waste that a general clinic wouldn't have. This guide covers every stream and the simplest compliant way to handle it.

The good news

One vendor can take your sharps, biohazard, and expired meds by prepaid mail-back kit, with a Certificate of Destruction and no contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Sharps

Injection, surgical, and procedure sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Injection needles & syringes
- Scalpel & nail-procedure blades
- Suture needles

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 02

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Wound-care and procedure waste with blood or tissue.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked gauze & dressings
- Tissue & nail debris with blood
- Contaminated PPE

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

WASTE STREAM 03

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired non-controlled medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired anesthetics & antibiotics
- Non-controlled injectables
- Samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 04

Controlled substances

If your practice stocks any Schedule II–V drugs.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V
- Wasted or partial doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, complete a DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, keep witnessed waste logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance / medication mail-back kit, to DEA standards.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The podiatry compliance checklist.

- ☐ Surgical and injection sharps in FDA-cleared containers, replaced at the fill line.
- ☐ Blood- and tissue-contaminated wound waste red-bagged as biohazard.
- ☐ Expired non-controlled meds destroyed with documentation.

- ☐ Any controlled substances non-retrievable with a Form 41.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS PODIATRISTS ASK

Your podiatry questions, answered.

Is nail and tissue debris regulated?

Only when it's contaminated with blood or OPIM — then it's biohazard. Clean clippings usually aren't; check your state's definition.

How do we handle surgical sharps?

Blades and needles go in an FDA-cleared sharps container and a sharps mail-back kit.

What about expired injectable anesthetics?

As pharmaceutical waste — destroyed with documentation, not trashed.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships prepaid mail-back kits sized to a podiatry practice — sharps, biohazard, and expired meds — destroyed at our DEA-registered facility with a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Surgical & injection sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Wound-care biohazard	Biohazard mail-back kit
Expired meds	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Controlled substances	Controlled / medication kit (Form 41)



Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Mail-back suits most podiatry practices. Surgical volume or multi-site? We'll size a program — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY PODIATRY PRACTICES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your podiatry practice waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop